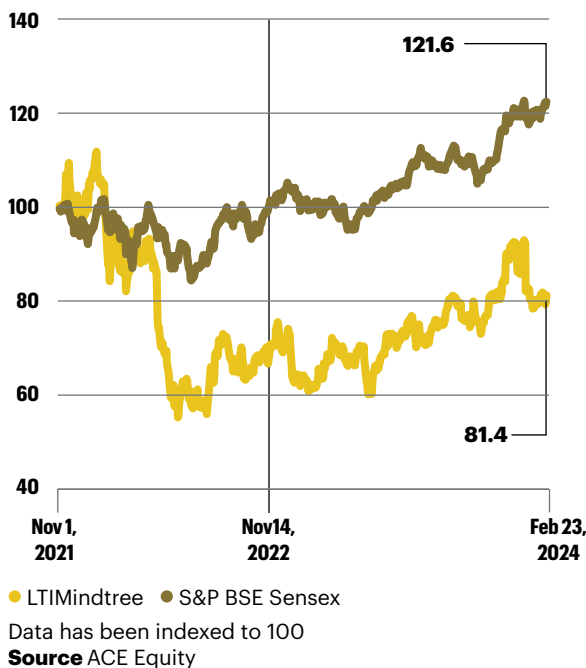


TAKING STOCK

► Shares of LTIMindtree have gained 14% in the past year, compared to benchmark index BSE Sensex's 23% rise

► Since trading as a single merged entity, LTIMindtree's shares are up 7%



COMPLEMENTARY VERTICALS AND INCREASED FIRM SIZE WOULD HELP IN GRABBING BIGGER DEALS... CROSS-SELLING AND UPSELLING AMONG CLIENTS, INCREASE IN GEOGRAPHIES WOULD ALSO HELP THE COMPANY TO DIVERSIFY CLIENTELE

REPORT BY BODHI CAPITAL

should do it in such a way that the two companies do not get distracted in any manner," says Chatterjee.

The steering committee consisted of a select group of people from both companies, with a few also coming from L&T. It was led by SNS himself and had multiple tracks established to oversee key verticals like human resources, finance, sales, and culture, among others.

"We had decided to do the merger in record time... every track was given six months," says Chatterjee. "We could not find any example of a merger that was completed in six to seven months. We took it up as a challenge, the reason being that if we could get the merger out of the way, then it would also help in having a unified go-to-market strategy," he says.

Incidentally, the cultural part was smoothly taken care of since there were a lot of commonalities between the two IT companies. "Almost 80% [of the] pillars were common... purpose, caring, learning, delivering results. We realised that culturally it was not much different, and we did a lot of cultural assimilations and workshops," says Chatterjee, who was heading the culture track. To be honest, six months was a bit of a stretch, but people really worked hard, he adds.

But the benefits were clearly visible. "Definitely, there is an acknowledgement among clients that LTI-Mindtree deserves a seat at the table. Our size is such that you cannot ignore us. Secondly, we are now very well positioned to compete with whoever it is, and we are winning too. All the metrics of the combined entity are looking much better," says Chatterjee.

Complementary verticals and increased firm size would help in grabbing bigger deals... Cross-selling and upselling among clients, increase in geographies would also help the company to diversify its clientele, says a report by investment fund Bodhi Capital.

Currently, the company boasts revenues in excess of \$4 billion, serving more than 700 clients in 30 countries, with a team of over 82,000 employees. With the merger in place and the combined entity functioning smoothly, the next goal is to expand the company's size and reach.

"I want to see LTIMindtree become a \$10-billion company. That is the vision that A.M. Naik and SNS have, and I think that is a fair vision. They want the services revenue to become a significant portion of the group's total revenue because services give a better margin. Do we have a vision to go up to \$10 billion? The answer is yes," says Chatterjee. **BT**

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